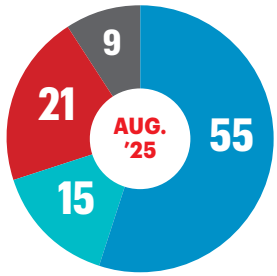
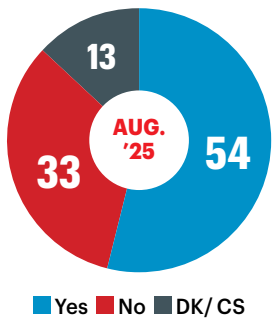
Q. How would you rate Op Sindoor as a response to Pakistan's terror attack in Pahalgam?



A majority believe the Indian response to Pahalgam was strong

Q. Do you believe the Union government provided truthful and transparent information about Operation Sindoor?



A third think that the Centre was not transparent about Op. Sindoor

Q. Which one of the following do you think brought ceasefire during Operation Sindoor?

PM Modi decided on his own	31
Pressure from US President Donald Trump	29
Request from Pakistan to India as it was hit hard	25
Rest, DK/ CS	



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All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

that continues to weaken the Opposition's challenge to the BJP and its allies in the NDA. The party's vote percentage remains stuck at 20.8, almost half of the BJP's 40.6 per cent, even if it has improved its tally by 19 seats as compared to the February 2025 MOTN survey and is only two short of the 99 it actually won in the 2024 LS election. The 26.8 percentage point gap in popularity between Rahul Gandhi and Modi remains high. Despite his spirited performance in calling out the Election Commission over 'vote rigging', he has a long way to go before he can project himself as a viable alternative to Modi. Especially as the BJP remains streets ahead in terms of organisational muscle and reach.

OVER 60% ARE WORRIED ABOUT TRUMP'S TARIFFS, BUT 54% BLAME AMERICA FOR THE BREAKDOWN IN INDO-US TRADE TIES; ONLY 22% THINK INDIA GOOFED

Save Democracy

However, if the Opposition could get its act together, there is enough discontent for it to tap into and challenge the BJP and NDA. In addition to the concern over a worsening economy, there is growing unease over the erosion of democratic norms. While 64 per cent believe elections in India are free and fair, a sizeable 32 per cent, or a third, think otherwise. Likewise, though a high 58 per cent dismiss the Opposition charge that the BJP manipulated voter rolls to win elections in Maharashtra and Haryana, a not-insignificant 35 per cent fear the worst. That feeling extends to the ongoing Special Intensive Revision of voter rolls for the upcoming Bihar assembly polls, where 58 per cent are confident that its intent is to ensure only eligible citizens vote, but 29 per cent do consider the timing to be suspicious and think the exercise is an attempt to help the ruling party.

The current MOTN survey also mirrors the growing discomfort over the violation or misuse of other democratic institutions. Asked whether BJP-appointed governors in Opposition-ruled states were playing a partisan role, as many as 61 per cent believe it might be the case. The perception that the BJP is misusing enforcement agencies such as the Enforcement Directorate (ED), Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the income tax department abides, with 46 per cent thinking this to be true. These misgivings have begun to colour public opinion about the judiciary as well, with only 37 per cent trusting it a great deal, 47 per cent expressing only partial faith in it and another 12 per cent distrusting it totally. Similarly, only 52 per cent feel they can speak freely about politics